

Name: _____

ENL1W CPT Presentation Brainstorming & Planning Sheet

Use this checklist to complete the rest of your CPT.

- ☐ Complete the Brainstorming Questions below
- ☐ Complete the storyboarding template for your Slideshow Presentation.
- ☐ Begin working on the media components you are planning to add (creating a book cover, trailer, video, etc).
- ☐ Work on Script for your presentation. Remember to annotate and add a works cited page at the end of the script
- ☐ Select a slideshow template and begin adding your components to the slideshow
- ☐ Rehearse your script
- ☐ Submit your brainstorming, CPT Notes, script, presentation, works cited page to the assignment folder. Ensure any links work on the day they are due. Any late submissions will be assigned a late penalty.

About the Book

1. What is the title and who is the author of your book?

The book is titled "Zero Day" and the author is David Baldacci. It was published in 2011

2. In one or two sentences, what is this book about?

This book is about a military investigator named John Puller who goes to a tiny coal mining town in West Virginia to figure out who killed a family. He finds out that the murders are actually part of a huge conspiracy that involves more than just a regular crime.

3. Demographics/Audience: Who do you think would enjoy this book and why? (You can think about books or tv shows that are similar to this book as well-- for example, *Harry Potter* fans might also enjoy this book).

People who like thrillers or the Jack Reacher books would probably like this. It is good for anyone who is into military stuff or mysteries where a small town has a lot of dark secrets.

Relevance

4. What are some important themes in your book?

One big theme is environmental damage because the coal mining is basically destroying the town and the people. Another theme is corruption because the people in charge are doing illegal

stuff just to make money.

5. How do these themes connect to real life today, especially for students your age?

The most important thing is that a family was murdered in Drake and the scene was so professional that the army had to get involved.

6. Why is this book particularly important in 2025?

This book is basically perfect for 2025 because it deals with stuff we see on the news every day like the energy crisis and the regular environmental damage from mining. People today are constantly talking about the human cost of climate stuff and this book shows that reality in a small town. It also hits on how much people do not trust the government right now which is something you would see if you were to doom scroll through social media for even five minutes.

Connection to English Class:

7. What English skills or concepts does this book help readers learn about? (e.g., theme, conflict, character development, voice)

You can learn a lot of regular English skills from this book like theme and conflict and how characters develop. It is a good example of how a setting can basically be its own character because the town of Drake is so important to the plot. You can also see how voice works because John Puller talks in a very specific military way that is different from how a regular person would explain things.

8. How could teachers use this book in class activities or discussions? Think about the current course texts or skills they may complement.

Teachers could use this book for class discussions about environmental justice or the ethics of corporate power. It would be a good way to practice analyzing "atmosphere" in writing because the descriptions of Drake are so vivid. It could also complement other course texts that focus on the "outsider" perspective or stories about characters who have to navigate corrupt systems.

Memorable Moments / Lessons

9. What are the 2-3 most important or emotional parts of the story?

One of the most emotional parts of the story is when you see how the coal mining has physically broken people like Howard Reed because it shows that the victims are not just the ones who were murdered but the whole town. Another important part is when Puller realizes the scale of the conspiracy because it turns a local murder into a massive threat that feels much more dangerous. The interaction between Puller and Sam Cole is also key because it shows two people from different worlds learning to trust each other while everything around them is falling apart.

10. What lessons do readers learn from those moments?

Readers learn that small crimes often hide much bigger problems and that you cannot always judge a situation by how it looks on the surface. From characters like Howard Reed we learn that industrial greed has a permanent human cost that lasts long after the money is made. The

friendship between Puller and Cole also teaches us that people can overcome their differences and work together if they have a common goal like finding the truth.

Marketing / Engagement Ideas

11. If you could redesign this book to attract new readers, what would you do? Would your idea get people interested in this book? Why do you think your new design is better?

If I had to redesign this book to get new people interested I would stop making it look like a regular army story. I would change the cover to show the dark mountains and the thick fog with maybe just one light from a mine to make it look spooky and mysterious. This would get people interested because it looks more like a thriller show you would watch on the weekend instead of just a military book. This design is better because it focuses on the creepy atmosphere of the town which is the most interesting part anyway

Quick Sketch

12. Which characters would you highlight in your campaign? What are the character traits you'd highlight about them?

Puller. I would focus on his hyper-efficiency and his tactical intelligence because it makes him seem like a "machine" that will not stop until he finds the truth

Sam Cole. I would highlight her toughness and her deep connection to the town because she represents the emotional side of the story and shows how the crime affects the local community

13. What are 5 quotes from the book that struck you as interesting and that you believe would act like a good teaser to the book? Include the proper MLA in-text citation.

1. "He didn't have a home, because the Army was his home" (Baldacci 7).
2. "The air in Drake didn't just smell bad; it felt heavy, like it was trying to push you into the ground" (Baldacci 42).
3. "In a place where everyone has a secret, the truth is the most dangerous thing you can find" (Baldacci 88).

4. "Puller didn't believe in coincidences. He believed in cause and effect" (Baldacci 115).
5. "They killed a family to keep a secret, which means the secret is worth more than four lives" (Baldacci 203).

14. What was the major conflict in the story you'd highlight for your campaign?

The major conflict I would highlight in my campaign is the "Man vs. Society" struggle where John Puller has to fight against a corrupt system that is designed to protect powerful people. This conflict is interesting because it is not just about a hero catching a criminal but about one person trying to uncover a secret that an entire town and even higher-ups in the government want to stay hidden.

15. Setting: Where and when does the story take place? What is the social condition? Do you think the setting is important to highlight in your campaign?

The story is set in Drake, West Virginia in the regular modern day. The social condition is basically nonsense because the town is broke and everyone is sick from breathing in toxic coal dust and sulfur dioxide. You see a bunch of cookie-cutter houses and rusted trucks and the whole place just feels falling apart. The setting is definitely the most important thing to show in a campaign because it creates a dark mood that explains why the mystery is so dangerous and real.

Campaign Media Checklist:

Which of the following products will you create for your campaign? (Check all that apply)

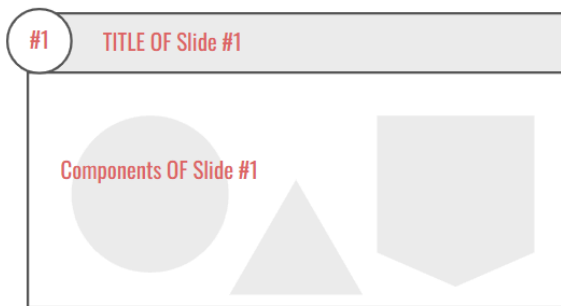
- ☐ New book cover design
- ☐ Movie poster or trailer concept
- ☐ TikTok video idea
- ☐ Instagram story/post concept
- ☐ YouTube vlog idea
- ☐ Sequel or prequel idea
- ☐ Character artwork or redesign
- ☐ Other: _____

*Additional information about the products can be found on the [CPT Media Project - Definitions, Examples, and Resources](#) document

16. What persuasive techniques do you plan to use in your presentation? (Check all that apply)

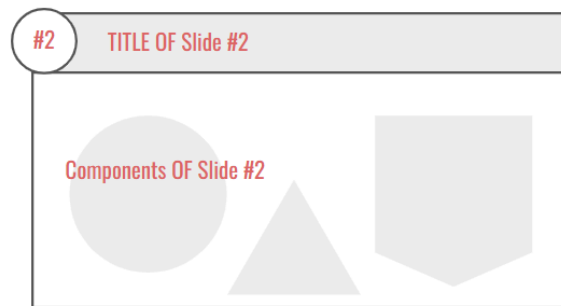
- ☐ Rhetorical questions
- ☐ Emotional appeals (Pathos)
- ☐ Logical appeal (Logos)
- ☐ Anecdote (storytelling)
- ☐ Literary Devices (simile, metaphor, onomatopoeia, etc.)
- ☐ Repetition
- ☐ Appeal to authority (mentioning experts or curriculum = ethos)
- ☐ Imagery or descriptive language

Begin planning your slideshow using the storyboard template below. Alternatively, a digital version is linked [here](#).



Use this space to create a brief summary of Slide #1.

Title page with book cover



Use this space to create a brief summary of Slide #2.

quick summery of book and attention cover

